Stem-cell decisions

Today I can… I can name a possible benefit and risk. I can ask for evidence that tests a claim. I can justify further research without claiming a cure.

Feedback: □ VF □ WS □ I □ NS □ E □ R □ [//] □ [?] _____

TA brief

Before the lesson

Prepare large fictional benefit/risk/evidence cards and desk mat. Check the local school risk assessment. The handling task is optional model rehearsal, not a core practical. Keep cards on the mat and pick up dropped cards.

Use a private predictable start. No cold calling, personal belief or family medical history. A learner may pass, use a valid alternative mode or exact scribe. Record adult prompting separately.

Prompt ladder

1. Point to the relevant place / instruction.
2. Ask one short question: "What is it asking you to find?"
3. Rephrase the instruction in simpler language.
4. Provide a scaffold or limited choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task to the pupil.

Arrival · 5 min

Invite one noticed detail on the fictional proposal card. No prior knowledge is required.

Starter · 3 min

Hear both attempts before revealing answers. Answers: differentiation; two matching daughter body cells; higher to lower concentration overall. Confirm actual taught coverage.

I do · 5 min

Pre-teach the four words. Model one complete fictional case. Ask whether “might help” proves treatment works. Expected no; an appropriate study is needed.

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TA brief · teach and hand over

We do · 7 min

Ask “The risk column is blank. What question could the panel ask?” Wait 5 seconds, point to the heading, then use the held ladder. Preserve missing-risk task and matching order. Include one-minute reset.

We do 2 · 5 min

Both show a response together. Correct D. Proceed when BOTH show benefit and risk evidence are needed. Re-model for an unsure learner and ask the parallel hinge while the other continues.

Independent · 8 min

Use ONE chosen route for the full 8 minutes. One learner presents a reason while the other asks for evidence, then switch. Each records their own reasoning. Adults agree actual roles and can support learners in turn; no large-group adult role is assumed. Include the source reset within the budget.

Review and improve · 4 min

Give precise VF or NS(+) only when it occurs. Invite a real edit and read-back. Include one-minute reset.

Exit · 3 min

Hear each response privately in a valid mode. Pass on deepest prompt, response mode and what was independent. Use the response to choose the next model or prompt.

Regulation and access

Check in before the hinge and chosen route. Give space and a single return step at the agreed pause signal. Collect no evidence during distress. Allow planning in any language while retaining the science challenge.

Task-specific cues within the held ladder

Use least prompt first and no physical prompting. Wait five seconds for a column choice. Point to a card heading and the last completed model sentence. Ask “What would a careful panel need to find out?” If needed, model the first benefit card only; the learner places the risk card. Place one card together only if needed, then invite a fresh evidence request independently. Record the deepest prompt used.

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